

SchnellPay Style Guide — v4 (Draft)

****Visual Design System · June 2026 · supersedes v3 (May 14, 2026)****

Dashboard · Admin · Marketing · Legal · Mobile

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****What's new in v4:**** three named themes (Marketing, Admin/Dashboard, Legal); the marketing-specific tokens (category palette, spacing, radii, card semantics) are now OFFICIAL ecosystem tokens; a full responsive system; a page-template registry.

01 — Ecosystem Tokens (single source of truth)

Every app's `globals.css` `:root` carries these. Canonical names are `--bg-\*`, `--gold-\*`, `--text-\*`, `--border-\*`, `--font-\*`; the `--color-\*` names are LEGACY ALIASES kept for backward compat and must always point at canonical tokens, never at raw hex.

Surfaces (darkest → lightest)

Token	Value	Use
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`--bg-darkest`	#141920	footer only
`--bg-input`	#1E2530	inputs, table heads, tab bars
`--bg-deep`	#252B36	sidebar, top bar — **never cards**
`--bg-base`	#2C3340	page background
`--bg-card`	#384254	cards, panels, modals

Gold

Token	Value	Use
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`--gold-core`	#C2A03F	PRIMARY — buttons, nav, badges, links
`--gold-brand`	#C9A84C	logo "PAY", marketing highlights only
`--gold-soft`	#E0C878	hover glow, accents only — never buttons/text
`--gold-dark`	#9A7D2A	depth, gradient endings

Marketing-only transparent golds (distinct from `--gold-soft`, a solid):
`--color-gold-soft` `rgba(194,160,63,0.4)` rings · `--color-gold-faint` 0.2 dividers ·
`--color-gold-tint` 0.10 active states.

Text — 3 tiers only. Never #FFFFFF.

`--text-primary` #F4F5F6 · `--text-secondary` #A7B0BC · `--text-subtle` #6B7A8D

Borders

`--border-default` `rgba(255,255,255,0.10)` · `--border-subtle` 0.07 ★ ·
`--border-faint` 0.04 · `--border-gold` `rgba(194,160,63,0.25)`

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### Status (system feedback ONLY, never decorative)
`--success` #4ade80 · `--warning` #facc15 · `--error` #f87171 · `--info`
#60a5fa

### Category palette (blog tags, tier accents, eyebrows) – now
ecosystem-official
business #34D399 · education #A78BFA · payments #60A5FA · security
var(--gold-core) ·
tax #FB7185 · teal #2DD4BF · warm #FB923C · mauve #E879F9
**Never for system feedback** – Received/Sent, completed/failed, up/down use
`--success`/`--error`, not the category greens/rozes.

### On-gold text + chain brand colors (NEW in v4)
`--text-on-gold` #0a0d12 – dark text on gold buttons/badges (the only
sanctioned
dark-on-gold value). Chain brand colors: `--chain-eth` #627EEA · `--chain-btc`
#F7931A · `--chain-sol` #9945FF – asset
icons/accents only.

### Spacing / Radii / Card semantics – ecosystem-official
Spacing: 4/8/12/16/20/24/32/36/40/48 (`--space-1...12`).
Radii: `--radius-sm` 8 · `--radius-md` 12 · `--radius-lg`
clamp(12px,1.5vw,20px) ·
`--radius-pill` 100px.
Cards consume `--card-*` tokens (bg/border/ring/radius/shadow/padding); change
once
in `:root`, every card updates. `--card-bg-default: var(--bg-card)` with
`--card-bg: var(--card-bg-default)` indirection for future variants.

### Fonts – per-app loading, same result
| Token | Resolves to | Loading |
|---|---|---|
| `--font-display` | Playfair Display | Marketing: next/font injects
`--font-playfair`, display references it first. Admin/Dashboard: raw string. |
| `--font-ui` | Jost | same pattern (`--font-jost` on marketing) |
| `--font-mono` | JetBrains Mono | all amounts, addresses, hashes, code |

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02 – The Three Themes

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### Theme A – Marketing (schnelpay.com)
– **Headlines (h1/h2 ≥ 24px): Playfair Display** (`--font-display`). Playfair
is a
display serif – large sizes ONLY.
– h3–h6, body, UI: **Jost** (`--font-ui`).
– Gold accents: `--gold-core` interactive; `--gold-brand` for brand highlights.
– Cards: `--bg-card` (#384254), `--radius-lg`, `--card-*` semantics.
– Category palette for blog tags and section eyebrows.

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Theme B – Admin / Dashboard (admin. / dashboard.schnelpay.com)
– ****Jost EVERYWHERE, including h1/h2.**** Playfair never appears – it is illegible at UI sizes and breaks density.
– Type scale (Jost): H1 24/700 · H2 20/600 · H3 16/600 · body 14/400 · labels 12/500 · eyebrow 11/700 CAPS ls:2px.
– ****JetBrains Mono for every number, amount, address, hash.****
– Status colors strictly for system feedback.

Theme C – Legal / Documents (terms, privacy, risk, compliance, beta)
Long-form legibility over display flair:
– Title: Playfair (it's marketing-site chrome) but ****all body Jost****.
– Body 15–16px, line-height 1.8–1.9, `--text-secondary`.
– Section headings 22–24px Jost 700 `--text-primary` – NOT Playfair (too small).
– "At a glance" summary card at top (`--bg-card`, gold checkmarks).
– Sticky "On this page" TOC on desktop; collapses above content on mobile.
– Meta line (version, governing law, dates) in `--text-subtle` 13px.
– Minimal gold: links + active TOC item only.

03 – Responsive System (NEW in v4)

Breakpoints (documented tokens – also used by media queries)
`--bp-sm` 640 · `--bp-md` 768 · `--bp-lg` 1024 · `--bp-xl` 1280 · `--bp-2xl` 1536

Containers
`--container-sm...2xl` = 640/768/1024/1280/1440. Standard wrapper:
``css
.container { width:100%; max-width:var(--container-xl);
margin-inline:auto; padding-inline:clamp(16px,4vw,32px); }
``

Never `width: 1200px` or fixed `padding: 40px` on page wrappers.

Fluid type tokens
`--text-xs...2xl` via clamp (e.g. `--text-2xl: clamp(2rem, 1.5rem + 2vw, 3rem)`).
Marketing h1: `clamp(2rem, 5vw, 4rem)`; h2: `clamp(1.5rem, 4vw, 3rem)`.

Fluid components
– Card padding: `--card-padding-y: clamp(20px,4vw,36px)`,
`--card-padding-x: clamp(16px,4vw,40px)` – fixes oversized mobile cards.
– `--radius-lg` is fluid (see Radii).

Hard rules
– Grids: 4-col → 2-col ≤768px; 3-col → 1-col ≤768px; 6-item grids ALWAYS `repeat(3,1fr)` – never auto-fit minmax.
– Tables: wrap in horizontal-scroll container on mobile.
– Media: `img, video, svg { max-width:100%; height:auto; }`
– Overflow: `body { overflow-x: clip; }` – ****clip, NOT hidden**** (hidden breaks

- sticky positioning; this was a deliberate May 6 fix – do not regress it).
- Motion: honor ``prefers-reduced-motion: reduce`` (kill animations/transitions).
- Sidebar (admin/dashboard): hidden $\leq 768\text{px}$, hamburger + drawer w-72, backdrop `rgba(0,0,0,0.6)`, z-50/z-40.

04 – Page Template Registry (NEW in v4)

Every marketing page declares which template it uses. Templates live in ``app/(templates)/`` and are the consistency contract – new pages/posts pick a template, never invent layout.

Template	Intended use	Audit verdict (Jun 10)
<code>`sp-tmpl-article-v001`</code>	Blog posts (long-form, single column)	
	canonical (on-gold token applied)	
<code>`sp-tmpl-content-v001`</code>	Content/legal pages (Theme C)	canonical
	(on-gold token applied)	
<code>`sp-tmpl-marketing-v001`</code>	Landing/feature pages (hero + card grids)	
	canonical (on-gold token applied)	
<code>`sp-tmpl-media-v001`</code>	Media-heavy pages	canonical – Playfair 72px stat is valid Theme A display
<code>`sp-tmpl-split-v001`</code>	Two-column split layouts	canonical – Playfair 28px stat $\geq 24\text{px}$ floor
<code>`sp-tmpl-dashboard-v001`</code>	Dashboard-style showcase	canonical after fixes: <code>bg</code> $\rightarrow$ <code>`--bg-darkest`</code> , <code>status</code> $\rightarrow$ <code>`--success`/`--error`</code> , <code>chains</code> $\rightarrow$ <code>`--chain-*`</code> tokens. Jost h1/h2 confirmed (Theme B compliant)

****Rule:**** every blog post is assigned a template (default: `article-v001`). The planned shared `<BlogPostLayout>` is the implementation of `article-v001`; the
~20
existing hand-rolled post pages migrate to it (Phase 2 of the migration).

04b – Blog System (publishing rules)

The blog is driven by a single source of truth: ``lib/blog-data.ts`` (the ``POSTS`` array). The index page (``app/(site)/blog/page.tsx``) and every category landing page read from it. ****A post does not exist until it is registered there**** – adding the ``page.tsx`` only makes the URL work; the post is invisible in navigation until it has a ``POSTS`` entry.

Publishing a new post – checklist

1. Create ``app/(site)/blog/<slug>/page.tsx`` using `<BlogPostLayout>` (Theme A).

2. Add ONE entry to `POSTS` in `lib/blog-data.ts` (slug, category, date, readTime, title, excerpt). The slug must match the folder exactly and be unique – a duplicate slug breaks the index render (React key collision).
3. `category` must be a valid `CategoryKey` (`security | business | payments | crypto | company`). The blog "Crypto Basics" tag = the `crypto` key (violet, `--color-cat-education`).
4. `date` format: `'Mon D, YYYY'` (e.g. `'Jun 9, 2026'`) – parseable by `new Date()`.
5. `tsc --noEmit` clean, preview locally, then commit + push (push deploys).

Featured-post rotation (the rule that surprised us – now codified)

The featured slot is ****automatic by date****, with an optional manual pin:

- ****Default:**** the NEWEST post by date is automatically featured. The previously featured post flows DOWN into the card grid in date order. So publishing a newer post automatically promotes it to Featured and demotes the prior one. No action needed.
- ****Pin (override):**** set `featured: true` on a post to PIN it as Featured regardless of date – use ONLY for an evergreen post you want kept up top for a long run (a launch announcement, a flagship explainer). Remove the flag to return to automatic date-based rotation.
- Implementation: `featuredPost()` returns `POSTS.find(p => p.featured) ?? postsByDateDesc()[0]`. At most ONE post should carry `featured: true` at a time.

Blog card layout (index grid)

Cards are flex columns with equal-height behaviour. To keep the grid visually clean:

- The excerpt has a fixed bottom margin; the ****date + "Read more →" are wrapped in a footer** `

` so they anchor to the BOTTOM of every card. This makes all "Read more →" links and dates align on a common baseline regardless of excerpt length. Never let the date/CTA float mid-card.
- Card surface `--bg-card`, `--radius-md`/`lg`, gold "Read more →" (`--color-gold`).

05 – Golden Rules (applied without being asked)

ALWAYS ✓

- `var(--token)` – never raw hex in component files (hex lives ONLY in `:root`).
- Cards `--bg-card` (#384254). Inputs `--bg-input`. Page `--bg-base`.
- Marketing h1/h2: `--font-display`. Admin/Dashboard ALL text: `--font-ui`.
- Playfair never below 24px, never in Admin/Dashboard, never for legal body.

- Amounts/addresses/hashes: `--font-mono``.
- Legal pages use Theme C scale.
- New pages/posts declare a template from the registry.
- Blog: register every post in `lib/blog-data.ts`` (unique slug); newest post auto-features, `featured: true`` only to pin an evergreen.
- Blog cards: date + "Read more →" anchored to card bottom (`marginTop: auto`` footer) for baseline alignment.
- `tsc --noEmit`` + `file`` check before every commit; Python `str.replace` for edits.
- Each repo commits separately; descriptive messages (feat · fix · style · refac · chore · blog).
- Blog rotation: newest post = featured; previous featured → card.

NEVER x

- Raw hex in components · #ffffff anywhere · #252B36 for cards.
- `--gold-brand`` for interactive elements · `--gold-soft`` for buttons/text.
- Playfair in Dashboard/Admin · non-mono for amounts.
- More than 3 text tiers.
- `body { overflow-x: hidden }`` (use clip).
- nano/sed for source edits · commit without TypeScript check.
- Real credentials/keys/passwords in chat.

06 – Deployment Reference (unchanged from v3)

Repo	URL	Platform	Deploy
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schnelpay-backend	api.schnelpay.com	Railway	push → auto ~60s
schnelpay-dashboard	dashboard.schnelpay.com	Cloudflare Pages	push → auto ~2min
schnelpay-admin	admin.schnelpay.com	Cloudflare Pages	push → auto ~2min
schnelpay-marketing	schnelpay.com	Cloudflare Pages	push → auto ~2min

****Migration note (June 2026):**** marketing token sync to ecosystem standard is in progress on branch `style-guide-migration``; merge to main only after page-by-page verification. Dashboard/admin to receive the v4 responsive tokens in their own commits.